MIL-P-0037564A(DLA-DM)
25 September 1978
USED IN LIEU OF
MIL-P-37564
6 February 1977

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

PLUGS, EAR, HEARING PROTECTION, UNIVERSAL SIZE, WITH HEADBAND

This limited coordination military specification has been prepared by the Defense Personnel Support Center based upon currently available technical information but it has not been approved for promulgation as a coordinated revision of MIL-P-37564. It is subject to modification. however, pending its promulgation as a coordinated military specification, it may be used in procurement.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers two types of hearing protection devices which provide a positive seal by distributing canal cap pressure over the ear canal for use in environments in which high intensity sound is encountered.

1.2 Classification. Ear plugs shall be furnished in the following types, as specified (see 6.1):

Types	
I	(without insulation on headband).
II	(with insulation on headband).
III	(to be worn under the chin and behind the neck; non-adjustable headband).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Issues of documents. The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bid or request for proposal form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.

MILITARY

MIL-P-116 - Preservation-Packaging, Methods of.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Defense Personnel Support Center, Directorate of Medical Materiel, DPSC-ATT, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 6515

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STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED. TEST METHOD STD. NO. 601 - Rubber: Testing and Sampling.

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

DRAWINGS

DEFENSE PERSONNEL SUPPORT CENTER (DPSC)

23220 Plug, Ear, Hearing Protection with Head Band.
23306 Plug, Ear, Hearing Protection, Universal Size, Plastic.
24404 Plug, Ear, Hearing Protection, Universal Size.

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bid or request for proposal shall apply.

AMERICAN NATIONAL STANDARDS INSTITUTE (ANSI)

ANSI S3.19 Method for the Measurement of the Real-Air Attenuation of Ear Protectors at Threshold.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American National Standards Institute, 1430 Broadway, New York, NY 10018.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.

3.1.1 Canal caps (Type I). The canal caps shall be made of neoprene and have a Shore Durometer A hardness value of 9 ± 1 when tested as described in 4.4.1. The canal caps shall be non-allergenic and resistant to body oils and acids.

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3.1.2 Canal caps (Pods, Type II). The canal caps (pods) shall be made of vinyl plastic and have a Shore Durometer A hardness value of 24 ± 2 when tested as described in 4.4.1. The canal caps (pods) shall be non-allergenic and resistant to body oils and acids.

3.1.3 Retainers. For the Type I, the retainers shall be made of neoprene and have a Shore Durometer A hardness value of 35 ± 2 when tested as described in 4.4.1. For the Type II and Type III, the screws shall be zinc plated steel and the nuts shall be nylon, nickel or cadmium plated brass.

3.1.4 Headband. The headband shall be made of austenitic stainless steel enclosed in a polyvinyl chloride tube. For the Type II, the headband polyvinyl chloride tube shall have a layer of polyurethane foam on the surface to be in contact with the wearer. For the Type III, the headband shall be made of butyrate acetate cellulose.

3.2 Design and construction. The ear plug shall consist of a canal cap or pod for each ear. Each canal cap (pod) shall fit into and seal the external auditory meatus. The canal caps are attached to the headband by the retainers. The Type I ear plug shall be in accordance with DPSC Drawing 23220. The Type II and Type III ear plugs shall be in accordance with DPSC Drawing 25306, except that the headband for the Type III shall be non-adjustable and made of plastic only with an ID of .13 ± .010 and an OD of .22 ± .010 inch. Overall height of loop shall be 5.15 ± 3/16 and width shall be 4.80 ± 1/2 inches. Detailed dimensions of the Type III ear plug are contained in DPSC Drawing 24404.

3.3 Sound attenuation. Sound attenuation shall be determined in accordance with the method described in 4.4.2. Attenuation shall exceed the following minimum values:

Frequency (Hz)	Type I Attenuation (db)	Type II & Type III Attenuation (db)
500	20	15
1000	26	16
2000	35	29
3000	37	36
4000	36	39
6000	--	35
8000	--	36

3.4 Workmanship. The finished ear plug shall conform to the highest standards of commercial fabrication. The ear plug shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability. The ear plug shall not cause irritation and shall be free from objectionable odor.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual and auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.1.3 Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the component/materials, may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government. The certificate shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the National Stock Number (NSN), the item identification, the name of the component/material, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, individual test results, and the specification requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and table I. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one ear plug.

TABLE I. Sampling for examination.

Defect	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Major	S-2	1.0
Minor	S-1	2.5

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4.2.2 For tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and table II. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one ear plug. Where feasible, the same sample unit shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

TABLE II. Sampling for tests.

Characteristic	Requirement	Test procedure	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Dimensions	3.2	---	S-1	1.5
Hardness	3.1.1 and 3.1.2	4.4.1	S-1	1.0
Attenuation	3.3	4.4.2	S-1	1.0

4.3 Examination. The ear plug shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements specified herein. Examination shall be conducted as specified in tables I and III. Examination however, shall not be restricted to defects listed in table III. Any ear plug in the sample containing one or more defects shall be rejected and, if the number of defective ear plugs in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

TABLE III. Classification of defects.

Categories	Defects
Major	
101	Headband does not hold adjustment.
102	Surfaces of ear caps in contact with wearer not free from roughness, burrs, or slivers.
Minor	
201	Surfaces not free from discoloration.
202	Feathers or burrs present on parts of ear plug other than parts in contact with wearer.
203	Canal cap retainers not tight.

4.3.1 Packaging inspection. The inspection of the preservation-packaging and interior package marking shall be in accordance with the group A and B quality conformance inspection requirements of MIL-P-116. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. The inspection of the packing and marking for shipment and storage shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of the applicable container specification and the marking requirements of MIL-STD-129.

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4.4 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.4.1 Hardness of canal caps and retainers. The hardness of the ear caps and retainers or pods shall be determined in accordance with Method 3021 of FED. TEST METHOD STD. NO. 601.

4.4.2 Sound attenuation. Sound attenuation shall be determined in accordance with ANSI S3.19.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Unit packaging. Each ear plug shall be packaged in a self-sealing plastic bag. Method of packaging shall be in accordance with MIL-P-116, method III. In addition, twelve bags containing type III plugs shall be further packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-566 or PPP-B-676. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

5.1.1.2 Intermediate packaging. Ten (10) ear plugs of type I or twelve (12) ear plugs of type II shall be packaged in a box of appropriate size constructed in accordance with PPP-B-636, type CF, class domestic. Closure of box shall be as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636. An intermediate package shall not be required for type III plugs.

5.1.2 Level C. Ear plugs shall be packaged in a manner that will afford adequate protection against corrosion, deterioration and physical damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity.

5.2 Packing.

5.2.1 Level A. One hundred (100) ear plugs of type I or one hundred forty-four (144) ear plugs of type II or twelve (12) unit packages containing type III ear plugs shall be packaged in a shipping container designed for a type 2 load and conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. Closure, strapping and water-proofing shall be as specified in the appendix of the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. One hundred (100) ear plugs of type I or one hundred forty-four (144) ear plugs of type II or twelve (12) unit packages containing type III ear plugs shall be packed in a shipping container designed for a type 2 load and conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the box specification.

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5.2.3 Level C. The packaged ear plugs shall be packed in shipping containers in a manner that will afford adequate protection against damage during direct shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. These packs shall conform to the carrier's rules and regulations.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Unit, intermediate and exterior container. Each unit intermediate and exterior container shall be marked as specified in MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents shall specify the following:

a. Title, number and date of this specification.
b. Type required (see 1.2).
c. Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
d. Applicable NSN.

6.2 This specification covers the following items listed in the Federal Supply Catalog:

National Stock Number	Item Identification	Type
6515-00-181-8058	PLUG, EAR, Hearing Protection, Universal Size, without Insulation on Headband	I
6515-00-392-0726	PLUG, EAR, Hearing Protection, Universal Size, with Insulation on Headband	II
6515-01-059-1821	PLUG, EAR, Hearing Protection, to be Worn Under-the-chin and Behind-the-neck only.	III

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6.3 Changes from previous issue. The margins of this specification are marked with an asterisk to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

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5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

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